



FOUR-COURSE SYSTEM

COURSE 3 - DATA ENGINEERING 2026

C3-02 Start Here

Exact route, Bridge boundary, first-use setup and assessment locks

Artifact	C3_02_START_HERE_BEGINNER_FIRST_RC1
Status	2026 - LEARNER EDITION
Phase	C3-02 Transformation Engineering & Warehousing 14 lessons 34-46 focused hours
Prerequisite	C3-01 Gate PASS. C2B warehouse/modeling foundations may be assumed; implementation depth is taught here.
Brand	Charcoal #1F2937 Teal #14B8A6 Soft Blue #3B82F6 AMOLED #000

House rule: analogy -> tiny example -> guided real tool -> break/fix -> independent changed version -> validation -> production reasoning -> evidence. A successful dbt command alone never proves correct data.



Exact route

- 1. Confirm C3-01 Gate PASS.
- 2. For L01-L02 use the book/practice only; do not install dbt yet.
- 3. Before L03, complete C3-029 and verify the dedicated Python 3.13 dbt/DuckDB environment.
- 4. Open the exact C3-030 lesson page, follow once, then close/minimize the lesson for Pxx.
- 5. Save code/config/output + uncertainty + independent validation in append-only evidence.
- 6. Only after a genuine attempt open matching C3-032 review; close it for the changed retry.
- 7. After L01-L14, complete BrightBasket Mini-Lab with limited hints.
- 8. Gate A TransitCare is independent. Reviews/tutorial solution hunting/AI solving are closed during the attempt.
- 9. Targeted repair never auto-opens B/C. Fresh full retest requires explicit assignment.

C2B -> C3-02 OVERLAP CONTROL

L01 is a deliberate revision: ETL/ELT already exists in C2B, but C3-02 uses it to choose transformation/replay boundaries. L02-L14 are deeper engineering progression: implementation, dbt

DAG/tests/incremental/history/macros/docs/dimensional integrity/query plans/CI. They must not be presented as if the Bridge taught production implementation.

PASS RULE

Lesson mastery and Gate PASS are competency/evidence decisions. No average, weighted-score or numeric compensation shortcut exists. A critical failure cannot be compensated by strength elsewhere.



Evidence folders

```
evidence/  
  L01/attempt_001/  
  L01/retry_001/  
  ...  
  MINI_LAB/attempt_001/  
  GATE_A/attempt_001/  
  REMEDIATION/<competency>/attempt_001/
```

Never overwrite an earlier attempt. Generated dbt target/log/database files are runtime outputs, not canonical source evidence unless a task explicitly asks for a captured log/report.

BOOK FALLBACK

Videos are visual companions. Every lesson contains enough explanation, example, recovery and validation to complete without external media. If a video is unavailable, use the book + official docs + course lab; do not block mastery on media availability.